PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Security | Incident Response | Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience protecting large-scale enterprise environments, most recently supporting an 8,000-user estate at the University of the Arts London (UAL). I specialise in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations, endpoint detection and response using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and log analysis within Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) environments. I bring proven expertise in alert triage, threat hunting, and incident response aligned with the National Institute of Standards and Technology Incident Response (NIST 800-61) framework and the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am experienced in developing detection logic, investigating structured security log data, and contributing to continuous improvement of security operations. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and thrive in collaborative, hybrid security teams where analytical rigour and cross-functional communication are valued.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL)), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk/Security Processing Language (SPL), detection rule authoring, alert triage and tuning
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight and Discover
- **Microsoft Security Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Cloud Apps
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end investigation, containment, eradication and recovery; NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK aligned playbooks
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation, Microsoft Sentinel playbooks
- **Threat Intelligence and Hunting:** Proactive threat hunting, Indicators of Compromise (IoC) analysis, MITRE ATT&CK Tactics Techniques and Procedures (TTP) mapping
- **Compliance and Governance:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Additional Tools:** Mimecast, Tanium, Check Point Harmony, Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) operations within Microsoft Sentinel, authoring Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules and analytics queries to identify threats across an 8,000-user Microsoft 365 environment.
- Conduct comprehensive log analysis and investigation of security events within Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), ensuring rapid triage and accurate categorisation.
- Drive end-to-end incident response lifecycle from detection through containment, eradication and post-incident review in alignment with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK frameworks.
- Perform proactive threat hunting across endpoint and identity data to identify attacker Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) not surfaced by automated alerting.

- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to streamline repetitive analyst workflows and reduce mean time to respond.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint protection platform including Falcon EDR, Prevent and Insight to detect, investigate and remediate endpoint threats at scale.
- Oversee Privileged Access Management (PAM) operations via BeyondTrust, enforcing least-privilege access across the enterprise.
- Partner with infrastructure, identity and IT operations teams to remediate vulnerabilities identified through Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) programmes.

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst

- Deployed and operationalised Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 devices, establishing centralised endpoint telemetry ingestion into Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection and response.
- Built and tuned Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) detection rules using Kusto Query Language (KQL) to reduce false-positive alert volumes and improve analyst efficiency.
- Investigated phishing campaigns, malware infections and identity-based threats using Microsoft Defender XDR, Mimecast email security and CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry.
- Maintained Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) configurations and Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations to minimise identity attack surface.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, prioritising remediation activity using risk-based scoring and MITRE ATT&CK mappings.
- Contributed to the development of security awareness training content and phishing simulation campaigns to reduce end-user risk.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation and ISO 27001 audit readiness activities.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Implemented and managed endpoint security controls, network security policies and access management procedures across the SaaS platform and corporate infrastructure.
- Supported security information and event management (SIEM) monitoring activities and conducted log analysis to identify anomalous behaviour and policy violations.
- Administered Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies to enforce compliance on corporate and bring-your-own-device endpoints.
- Contributed to quality assurance processes and infrastructure projects including cloud migration initiatives on Microsoft Azure.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) rollout across 8,000 users at UAL, establishing full endpoint telemetry visibility within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Developed and deployed SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced analyst manual triage workload by automating repetitive alert classification tasks.
- Led an organisation-wide CrowdStrike Falcon deployment, improving detection fidelity and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for endpoint threats.
- Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification and ISO 27001 audit readiness, contributing evidence packs and control documentation.
- Designed and operationalised a proactive threat hunting programme aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying previously undetected persistence mechanisms in the environment.

EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.) - Environmental and Resource Engineering
- Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) - Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)